Ultimately, the decisions implemented by the military are taken at the political level and, there, as I have already wondered, how much does Netanyahu have to say? I have described him as a cautious politician. He was that in the past. But did the catastrophe of October 7, and the responsibility he carries for it, change him to the point of rejecting US appeals for greater caution in unleashing whatever violence is feasible? It could be. If so, Israel risks paying the price for Netanyahu's need to justify himself with yet another series of miscalculations. Or can one rely on the levelheaded members of the war cabinet to tell him when enough is enough?

Israel is caught in a horrible dilemma for which there is only one solution, a most improbable one: Hamas has to abandon its goal of destroying Israel and recognize its right, like that of every other state, to live in peace with its Palestinian neighbors, who also have the right to a state of their own. In other words, the two-state solution has to come with the cessation of hostilities and the acceptance of it by Hamas and Israel. But in Israel there are too many right-wingers to accept a two-state solution, and Hamas would have to stop being Hamas to accept a peaceful solution. What then is in store for the next decade at least and probably for a whole generation? There will be truces which can last for a few years, with the certainty of further explosions.

Today, another kind of explosion: the letter sent in March by the chief of intelligence to Netanyahu, outlining in detail the strategic conjuncture for an attack on Israel, has been published. The analysis uses general terms but is correct in its conclusion: the enemies of Israel can use the internal turmoil in the country to attack it. Netanyahu disregarded any kind of such warning and, instead, opted for the dismissal of Defense Minister Gallant. He was compelled to rescind the dismissal because of the huge protests it provoked, but he didn't pay any attention to the warning from the intelligence services.